



PROGRESS REPORT

Sierra Leone: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-05 · 92 systems and instruments tracked

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-05.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy	A spectrum licensing and management framework exists as the regulator's stated position at an international trade event rather than as an adopted instrument. The regulator set out its asks on spectrum pricing and management at an international congress in March 2026 (framework). That is a position, not an instrument: no consultation, draft or adopting decision follows it in the base. A national broadband strategy running 2023 to 2028 is named only in passing, through the university connectivity programme recorded elsewhere.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	A National AI Strategy is in development, with a draft readiness diagnostic produced and consultations run. The draft diagnostic and the consultations are what the base holds; no strategy text, timetable or adopting decision is on record (strategy). What exists instead is an artificial-intelligence-in-government partnership already delivering training, and a public awareness campaign on deepfakes. Both are recorded separately, and both run ahead of the strategy that would frame them.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy	Cabinet approved a National Data Protection Policy in April 2026, above a National Data Strategy issued in 2023 and updated with donor support. The policy was approved by Cabinet on 21 April 2026, and the same decision authorised the Bill that would give it force (policy). The data strategy carries January 2023 as the date on the document; the ministry's own index files it as February 2023 and the formal launch was later again, so three dates exist for one instrument. It was updated over five months with donor support and aligned to the continental data policy framework (strategy , update).	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	Cabinet authorised a Data Protection and Right to Access Information Bill in April 2026, and the country has had no data-protection law in force throughout the period. The Bill was finalised in November 2025 and Cabinet approved the policy and authorised the Bill on 21 April 2026 (bill , finalisation). No data-protection law has been in force at any point in the period. That is the frame for everything else in this unit: a biometric register covering most of the population, subscriber data disclosed to police, an identity migration in pilot and two competing identity platforms, all operating with no statutory data-protection regime behind them.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id	Subscribers Regulations 2025 began a phase-out of unregistered subscriber cards, and government conceded the identity linkage is incomplete in a ministerial statement. The phase-out was announced on 30 July 2026, linking registration to the national identification number. The instrument's own text is not held and does not appear in the regulator's public register (regulations). Government conceded on 4 August 2026 that the linkage is incomplete (linkage , phase-out). That concession matters because the fraud response recorded elsewhere rests on registration and identity verification as its principal control, and the control is admitted to be partial.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation	A Public Financial Management Act 2026 went to stakeholder consultation in August 2026 covering digital payments, and the National Communications Authority Act 2022 was tested against the fraud wave in a published legal analysis. The draft was consulted on in Freetown in August 2026; no text, parliamentary stage or commencement date is published (draft). The communications Act was tested against the mobile-money fraud wave in a published legal analysis in July 2026 (Act). Between them and the cybercrime Act the country has statutes that reach the conduct. What it does not have, recorded separately, is a rule allocating the loss.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation	A public-private dialogue was convened to operationalise the Electronic Transactions Act 2019, seven years after enactment, and the Act as enacted and gazetted is not held. The dialogue ran over two days in July 2026 with donor support (dialogue , framework). The Act as enacted and gazetted is not held; every automated route to the text failed as at August 2026, and what the base has is a record of the instrument rather than its provisions (record). An Act that needs a dialogue to operationalise it seven years after passage is the clearest instance in this unit of the gap between enactment and effect.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Data protection	Data protection authority	Cabinet authorised repeal of the information commission Act and a merged dual-mandate authority covering data protection and access to information. The existing Right to Access Information Commission would be repealed and replaced by a single authority holding both mandates (merger). No establishing text, commencement date, budget or staffing is published. Until the Bill passes, the country has an access-to-information regulator and no data-protection regulator at all.	ADVANCED
Data protection	National data protection readiness	Data protection by design training was delivered to the state technical team, while police requests for subscriber data are answered with no warrant requirement or oversight mechanism on the record. The training was delivered in August 2026, and no curriculum, attendance figure or follow-on compliance requirement is published (training). An operator answers police requests for subscriber verification data, and no warrant requirement, oversight mechanism or reporting duty governing those disclosures is on the record (disclosures). Training the builders while the disclosure route is ungoverned is the shape of readiness here: the design principle is being taught and the statutory basis does not exist.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	The country attended the inaugural board meeting of a continental health intelligence body in August 2026, and no constitutive instrument, budget or data-sharing arrangement is published. Membership was taken up and the inaugural board meeting attended (membership). Nothing published states what the body does with member states' health data, which is the question a country with no data-protection law in force most needs answered before joining a health information hub.	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	Free roaming with two neighbours took effect in May 2025, a third agreement was signed in November 2025, and networks were interconnected at the Guinea border. The three-country free roaming took effect on 2 May 2025 (roaming), and a further agreement with a fourth neighbour was signed at a regional summit in November 2025 and remains planned (agreement). Networks were interconnected at the Pamelap border in June 2025 (interconnection). That border link is also where the country's search for cable redundancy runs: it has one landing station on record and is seeking a second route through the same neighbour.	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	National interoperability standards		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	National quality standards	A national open-source software policy for the public sector was approved in 2025, and nothing on file records its application to any procurement. The policy was approved in 2025 and reaches the base through coverage of a university curriculum event (policy). No implementation guidance, compliance route or procurement decision is recorded under it. The identity migration in pilot is to an open-source platform, which is the only place the policy's direction and a live system coincide.	NO CHANGE
Standards	Adoption of international standards		NO EVIDENCE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy		NO EVIDENCE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy		NO EVIDENCE

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation		NO EVIDENCE
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships		NO EVIDENCE
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance	An innovation investment fund was announced with a target stated at an exhibition, and a smartphone financing scheme was announced between an operator, a bank and a handset maker. The fund's target was stated at a digital public goods exhibition in July 2026, with no manager, structure, first close or committed capital held (fund). The financing scheme is a commercial arrangement, and no price, interest rate, eligibility test or uptake figure is stated (scheme). Device affordability is the constraint the usage-gap evidence points at, and the only instrument aimed at it is a private arrangement whose terms are unpublished.	ADVANCED
New investments	Development-partner project financing	A US\$137m regional digital integration operation was approved in March 2026, and technical assistance for census digital mapping was committed for the 2026 population census. The operation was approved by the lender's board on 13 March 2026 (operation). The census mapping assistance is a commitment record rather than a delivery report: no enumeration date, mapping coverage or equipment is stated (assistance). Between them these are the only two development financings the base holds for this unit, and one of them is the largest single instrument in it.	ADVANCED

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	The state operator is being relaunched as a mobile virtual network operator, with a commercial partner appointed in April 2026. The investment partner was appointed in April 2026 (relaunch). No launch date, subscriber target, spectrum arrangement or wholesale price is published. A state operator re-entering the market as a virtual operator on a competitor's network is a structural choice the record states without explaining.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Internet usage		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	Mobile affordability	Sierra Leone entered the regional free roaming agreement in February 2026, removing charges with Liberia and Ghana. The agreement entered in February 2026 removes roaming charges among Sierra Leone, Liberia and Ghana, with the regulator stressing that full implementation still had to follow. It is a cross-border price, not a domestic one: nothing in the base publishes a Sierra Leonean retail tariff or an affordability ratio against income.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	The national fibre backbone reaches 14 of 16 districts, a marginal advance with the last two districts unstated as to timing. Backbone coverage was reported at 14 of 16 districts in May 2026 (backbone , centre , ambition). No date, cost or route is stated for the remaining two, and no utilisation or last-mile figure accompanies the coverage count. The evidence recorded separately is that the gap in this country is usage rather than reach.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth	A wholesale operator added new subsea capacity to its West Africa network in July 2026, and an ECOWAS four-country cable cleared feasibility in October 2025. The added capacity serves a wholesale route across several West African states and is not a national asset (capacity). 2025-07-11 - a ministry delegation assessed feasibility and public-private models for a second landing routed via Guinea , and nothing further on that route is held. 2025-10-22 - separately, ECOWAS member-state experts with their technical and financial partners reviewed and approved the feasibility study for a second submarine cable serving Cabo Verde, Liberia, Sierra Leone and Guinea-Bissau at a Monrovia workshop; no route, cost, landing site or construction date is published, and neither record says whether the two are the same project. A single landing station is the most concentrated infrastructure risk in this ledger, and until one of these is built it stays that way.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	Satellite service has been licensed since June 2024 with three local resellers, and twelve universities were connected under the national broadband strategy. The service has been licensed since June 2024 and operates through three local resellers (licence , universities). Twelve universities were connected through a local reseller under the broadband strategy (connection). Licensed satellite service reaching universities and, separately, health facilities makes one foreign operator the connectivity of last resort for two national systems at once.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	A national data centre was commissioned in April 2026, an identity agency facility was reported operating in August, and an operator backup facility opened in November 2025. The national facility at the regulator's headquarters was commissioned by the head of state in April 2026 (national). The identity agency's director-general reported a tier-three facility operating in August 2026 (identity), and an operator opened a backup facility outside the capital in November 2025 (backup , figures). Three facilities commissioned inside eighteen months, and no capacity, tenancy or redundancy arrangement is published for any of them.	ADVANCED
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)		NO EVIDENCE
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Grid reliability	A solar and storage plant became fully operational in July 2026, and dispatch centres and control upgrades are provided for in a compact. The plant was commissioned in July 2026; the access projection attached to it is the project's own, and no generation outturn, grid-availability series or measured effect on telecommunications uptime is held (plant). Dispatch centres and control-system upgrades are provided for in the compact and have not moved in the base (compact). Grid reliability is the unstated dependency under three data centres and a national fibre backbone, and there is no series in this base against which to read it.	ADVANCED
Energy	Rural electrification		NO EVIDENCE
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software		NO EVIDENCE
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	The regulator confirmed ongoing cybersecurity incidents in a July 2026 public notice, and six offences under the Cyber Security and Crime Act 2021 were mapped onto the mobile-money scam in a published analysis. The public notice confirming ongoing incidents was issued on 30 July 2026 (notice), and a coordination centre is named as a delivery partner in senior civil-service training (centre , strategy). A published legal analysis maps six offences under the 2021 Act onto the scam (offences). No prosecution under any of them is on record. The regulator ran a consumer education campaign on online fraud from July 2026 (education). Awareness is doing the work the statute is not.	MIXED a coordination centre and a public notice on live incidents while the statute in force is being read against a fraud wave rather than applied to it

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system	The finance ministry reported piloting a data exchange layer on an open-source exchange platform, above a service bus that reaches the base only as a prototype terms of reference. The pilot was reported in August 2026 (pilot), and the service bus above it is held as a prototype terms of reference and nothing further (prototype). No connected agency count, go-live date or governing instrument is published. The identity agency's own argument, made at the same consultation, is that identity should come first — which is a position on sequencing rather than a description of what exists.	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	An open-source migration of the identity system completed pilot and is still seeking funding, while a second national digital identity platform went to private-sector consultation. The migration pilot is complete and full implementation is still seeking funding (migration , identity first). A separate platform is being built with a foreign government and a foundation, and went to private-sector consultation on a trusted digital identity framework in August 2026 (consultation , dialogue , partnership). The identity agency has warned publicly against parallel identity systems, so the duplication is contested inside government rather than merely observed from outside. One route is funded and unbuilt, the other piloted and unfunded.	MIXED an open-source migration piloted and unfunded while a second identity platform is being built and the identity agency warns against parallel systems
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	The identity agency reported about 93 per cent population coverage, and registration, card issuance and coverage are three different metrics kept apart in the record. Coverage was reported to a digital public infrastructure consultation in August 2026 and has not moved in the base since a 2025 statement of the same figure (coverage , services , opportunity). Card issuance is tracked separately because registration, issuance and coverage measure different things and conflating them would overstate what a person actually holds (issuance). An ethnographic study documents human intermediation in enrolment – brokers standing between the citizen and the register – reported as analysis rather than as a state position (brokers).	NO CHANGE
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems	A national digital farmer registry was agreed for integration with the identity number in May 2025, and an agricultural voice-response platform is reported 98 per cent complete. The registry integration was agreed with the agriculture ministry in May 2025 and has not moved since (registry). The voice-response platform is described as 98 per cent complete, which is the ministry's own description (platform); no launch date, language coverage, call volume or cost is stated (platform). Neither carries a data-protection arrangement, in a country with no data-protection law in force.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection	The revenue authority began distributing smart tax machines to 10,000 registered businesses from 31 August 2026, alongside the existing electronic cash register system. Nationwide distribution of smart goods and services tax machines to 10,000 registered businesses began on 31 August 2026 (distribution). The commissioner-general said the machines complement the existing electronic cash register system and are intended to support accurate record-keeping, strengthen tax compliance, let businesses issue valid receipts and reduce revenue leakages, as part of a domestic revenue mobilisation drive (distribution). The machines are counted against no published total of registered businesses, no distribution schedule, no cost and no baseline for the leakage they are to reduce.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality	A national instant payment switch launched in February 2025 with full integration from April, and a payments platform with a messaging chatbot and code settlement launched in April 2026. The instant phase launched on 13 February 2025 with full integration from 1 April 2025 (switch). The payments platform launched in April 2026 with a messaging-app chatbot and code-based settlement (platform). No transaction volume, participant count or availability figure is published for the switch at any date, so what the rail actually carries is unmeasured.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	A prepaid card requiring no bank account and a virtual card through an operator app both launched in 2026, and financial inclusion reaches the base only as a named-analyst assessment. The prepaid card launched in May 2026 with a bank partner and requires no bank account (prepaid), and a virtual card launched in March 2026 through an operator application (virtual). A savings product paying annual interest through an application and short codes launched in November 2025 (savings), and a multi-currency wallet and card launched in April 2025 (wallet). The inclusion rate itself is a named-analyst assessment rather than an official series, so five products can be dated and the population they reach cannot (inclusion).	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection	A national fraud roadmap was validated in August 2026, and no rule allocating the loss is held. The roadmap was validated at the close of a two-day workshop convening the operator, two ministries, the regulator and the central bank on registration, verification compliance and fraud reporting (roadmap , workshop , strategy). Its text, costing and timetable are not held, and the gap it addresses is unchanged: no liability rule, refund duty or reversal mechanism is proposed, so the consumer's position after a fraud is exactly where it was (alert , parliament). Two published analyses disagree on whether the problem is absent law or unenforced law, and the disagreement is unreconciled (scam , enforcement , allocation). Complaint volumes are operator-reported in a ministerial statement with no series and no earlier figure (complaints), and the operator's own scam-alert tool publishes no report volume, response time, remedy or referral route (tool).	MIXED a multi-agency fraud roadmap validated while no rule allocates the loss and the consumer's position after a fraud is unchanged
Registries	Population register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Civil register	Supplier engagement opened for an integrated digital mortality surveillance, registration and certification system, and no cost, supplier, timetable or coverage target is stated. Engagement opened in August 2026 (system). The coverage figure attached to it is the agency's own. Death registration at that level means the civil register captures a small fraction of deaths, which is what the system is meant to change and what nothing yet measures.	ADVANCED
Registries	Address register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Business register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Social protection register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Electoral register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Tax register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Land register		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Health	A digital health information system and electronic medical records rollout launched at its first facility in July 2026. The science and technology directorate and the pharmacy board signed a memorandum to advance digital pharmaceutical regulation (memorandum). The rollout launched at a paediatric centre on 27 July 2026 alongside the connectivity that carries it (rollout , launch). No facility count, record volume, interoperability arrangement or data-protection basis is published. The connectivity underneath it is a single foreign satellite operator under no public contract, so the health record and its transport share one point of failure.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Education		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Justice		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Tax		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Customs	The anti-corruption commission found an integrity failure in the customs system at the revenue authority, and no response, prosecution or remediation is on record. The commission's report is dated July 2026 and was serialised from August (report , audit). The report is held only as far as its background section, serialised verbatim, and the figure attached to it comes from a newspaper account of the same investigation rather than from the report. No revenue-authority response, prosecution or remediation is on record. A customs system whose integrity has been found wanting by the state's own anti-corruption body, with nothing published since, is the single clearest regression in this unit.	REGRESSED
Sectoral management information systems	Land		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	Digitisation of government services is agency-reported with no service list or definition published, and three back-office systems – procurement, monitoring and audit – are in progress. The government launched a digital jobs portal stated as intended to break the nepotism cycle in youth employment (launch). No vacancy or placement figure is on the base. The digitisation figure is agency-reported, with no service list or definition published, so it cannot be checked against any service a citizen would use (services). Electronic procurement is advancing through bilateral cooperation with a neighbour whose own system is described as a regional model (procurement , model). A national monitoring and evaluation system is expanding with no coverage figure, publication rule or public access to the tracked project data stated (monitoring), and an audit management system completed post-configuration training with no cost, go-live date or audit scope stated (audit).	ADVANCED

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government		NO EVIDENCE
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics	Satellite connectivity for 300 government health facilities launched its first site in July 2026, placing a national health dependency on one foreign operator with no public contract. The first site was launched at a paediatric centre on 27 July 2026 (launch , site). It places a national health information dependency on a single foreign satellite operator with no public contract. No value, term, service level or exit arrangement is published, and no alternative transport is named for any of the 300 facilities. That is the finding rather than the rollout: the country has chosen the fastest route to connecting its clinics and has published nothing about what happens if it stops.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations		NO EVIDENCE

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration	An artificial-intelligence-in-government partnership signed in October 2025 delivered cyber and artificial-intelligence training for senior civil servants in March 2026. The electoral commission publicly considered the use of artificial intelligence for the 2028 elections (report). Nothing states what function is contemplated or what safeguards would apply. The memorandum was signed at a United Nations session in October 2025 (partnership), and training for senior civil servants followed in March 2026 with the cyber coordination centre as a delivery partner (training). No system, deployment, cost or evaluation is published. The partnership is running ahead of the national strategy that would frame it, which is in development.	ADVANCED
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems		NO EVIDENCE
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems		NO EVIDENCE
AI	Control of AI abuse	A deepfake and digital misinformation campaign has run since May 2026 across seven towns, with no legislative or platform-facing instrument accompanying it. The campaign has reached seven towns since May 2026 (campaign). No legislative or platform-facing instrument accompanies it: public literacy is standing in for regulation. That is the same substitution the fraud response makes, where consumer education runs while no rule allocates the loss.	ADVANCED
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production		NO EVIDENCE
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs		NO EVIDENCE
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem		NO EVIDENCE

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)	A civil service digital skills programme launched in July 2026 with 1,000 places in its first year. The programme launched with 1,000 first-year places (programme). No curriculum, completion measure or departmental coverage is published. It sits alongside the separately recorded senior civil-service training on cyber and artificial intelligence, and nothing states how the two relate.	ADVANCED
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)		NO EVIDENCE
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education		NO EVIDENCE
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications	A digital public goods university curriculum held its first academic exhibition in July 2026. The exhibition was held on 27 July 2026 (curriculum). The same event carried the announcement of the innovation investment fund and the reference to the open-source policy, so one exhibition is the source for three of this unit's forward commitments. No enrolment, institution count or graduate figure is published for the curriculum.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem	A youth digital-literacy programme graduated eighty in August 2026, donor-funded and delivered by a non-governmental academy. Eighty graduated in August 2026 (programme). The outcome reports are the graduates' own and no tracer study is held, so what the programme produced beyond attendance is unmeasured. It is the only youth training instrument in this ledger.	ADVANCED
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy		NO EVIDENCE

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Gender equity		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides	Internet penetration is unchanged, and the gap the evidence points at is usage against investment rather than coverage. A separate 2024 estimate is on file alongside the current figure; the definitions differ and both are kept dated rather than merged (penetration , estimate). The usage measure sets telecommunications investment against what is actually used; its price series is an attributed opposition critique rather than an official statistic (usage , critique). Backbone reaching 14 of 16 districts against a usage gap of this shape is the argument for device affordability and price over further build, and the only instrument aimed there is a private financing scheme with unpublished terms.	NO CHANGE

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics		NO EVIDENCE
National statistics	Censuses and surveys		NO EVIDENCE
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data		NO EVIDENCE
Open data	Use of open data		NO EVIDENCE
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data	A coordination and visualisation platform launched in July 2026 under a geospatial memorandum, and a national base map is in development with a feasibility mission still ahead. The platform launched on 6 July 2026 under a memorandum signed the previous week (platform). The base map was announced in August 2026 with the feasibility mission still to come (base map). Neither states a data-licensing arrangement, and both are delivered with foreign partners. The country is acquiring a national geospatial layer through partnerships whose terms are unpublished.	ADVANCED
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments	Officials joined a south-south learning mission to India on digital public infrastructure, the base's first record of engagement with India here. Senior officials from the digital and ICT sector and line ministries joined delegations from four other African states and the African Union Commission on a learning mission to India hosted by the United Nations Development Programme, to study India's digital public infrastructure and the institutions that built it; the state government of Karnataka received the delegation in Bengaluru on 1 September 2026 (mission , visit). An exposure visit and nothing more: no agreement, financing, technology transfer or follow-on commitment is named on either side.	ADVANCED

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Allocation of loss for mobile-money fraud	Two published analyses disagree on whether the problem is absent law or unenforced law; unreconciled as at 2026-08-09.	not yet probed
Domestic technical capacity to operate the national digital estate	A staffing, skills-audit or operations report from NaTCA, DSTI or the NCRA covering who runs the national systems and with what capacity.	not yet probed
Digitalisation of local councils	A local government digital plan, a council-level service platform, or a district administration report on digital service delivery.	not yet probed
European Union digital cooperation with Sierra Leone	A Global Gateway or EU delegation announcement, a financing agreement, or a programme document naming Sierra Leone.	not yet probed
Indian digital cooperation with Sierra Leone	A bilateral memorandum, a line-of-credit agreement, or an India Stack or ITEC programme document naming Sierra Leone.	not yet probed
Gulf state digital investment in Sierra Leone	An investment agreement, data-centre or connectivity commitment from a Gulf sovereign fund or operator.	not yet probed
Domestic budget appropriations for the digital sector	The Ministry of Finance appropriation act or budget speech showing the votes for MoCTI, NaTCA, DSTI and the NCRA.	not yet probed
NCRA-SLRSA register-to-register data-sharing agreement	The signed agreement or a published summary stating what data classes flow, on what legal basis and with what retention limit.	2026-08-09
Legal basis for data sharing between government registers	A data-sharing instrument, regulation or protocol governing exchanges between the identity register and other agencies.	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
United States bilateral health agreement and its data-sharing agreement	The memorandum of understanding and the related data-sharing agreement themselves, a signature date, or a Sierra Leonean government statement naming the instrument. The text is withheld rather than unpublished, and is in litigation in the United States District Court for the District of Columbia	not yet probed
Bank of Sierra Leone RTGS and ACH re-platforming	An award notice from the Bank of Sierra Leone or the National Public Procurement Authority for references 8922483/8922484, naming supplier, value and scope. The only listing found was an inadmissible-origin tender aggregator, retired 2026-08-10; neither contracting authority's procurement page carries a matching entry.	2026-08-10

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.